for several different uses; it can be treated as an array, list (vector), hash table (an implementation of a map), dictionary, collection, stack, queue, and probably more. As array values can be other arrays, trees and multidimensional arrays are also possible.

Arrays in PHP is a type of data structure that allows us to store multiple elements of similar data type under a single variable thereby saving us the effort of creating a different variable for every data. The arrays are helpful to create a list of elements of similar types, which can be accessed using their index or key. Suppose we want to store five names and print them accordingly. This can be easily done by the use of five different string variables. But if instead of five, the number rises to a hundred, then it would be really difficult for the user or developer to create so many different variables. Here array comes into play and helps us to store every element within a single variable and also allows easy access using an index or a key. An array is created using an array() function in PHP.

## 5.1 ARRAY FUNCTIONS

These functions allow you to interact with and manipulate arrays in various ways. Arrays are essential for storing, managing, and operating on sets of variables.

### 5.1.1 Installation

There is no installation needed to use these functions; they are part of the PHP core.

### 5.1.2 Runtime Configuration

This extension has no **configuration** directives defined in php.ini.

### 5.1.3 PHP Array Constants

| Sr.No | Constant & Description |
|---|---|
| 1 | **CASE_LOWER**<br><br>Used with array_change_key_case() to convert array keys to lower case |
| 2 | **CASE_UPPER**<br><br>Used with array_change_key_case() to convert array keys to upper case |
| 3 | **SORT_ASC**<br><br>Used with array_multisort() to sort in ascending order |